

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It's time to save the environment if we want to avoid the worst case scenario!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe events in the news in a range of social and work contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write about natural disasters.
- I can talk about local and international news.
- I can express complex statements using words like *who*, *that* or *which*.

Ask your partner:

- What kind of weather do you like? Why?
- What kind of weather have you never experienced?
- Have you ever experienced extreme weather conditions? What were they like?





Let's Explore!

Sally finds out why we cannot be **in denial*** of climate change.

* When you are in "in denial" of something, you refuse to believe it is true.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** As someone who is constantly studying weather phenomena, what can you tell us about the increase in natural disasters globally?
- Brock Tameland:** During my recent travels, I was shown the negative effect of climate change by many concerned locals. The fields that they own are getting drier. The freshwater lakes that they use are becoming saturated with pollutants ... This is made even worse by tornadoes and heat waves in the summer, and ice storms and blizzards in the winter.
- Sally:** Are you saying that the weather is becoming more extreme?
- Brock Tameland:** Absolutely. The current patterns have become impossible to predict. The data that was collected by our colleagues 20 years ago is now obsolete. The scientists who first studied climate change never imagined that things would get so bad in such a short amount of time.
- Sally:** This seems to be a problem which people keep ignoring, though.
- Brock Tameland:** I agree. Many books were published by world-renowned authors on the subject. Even Hollywood is playing its part by releasing blockbusters that are raising awareness on this issue.
- Sally:** I think some of those movies were even made by the same director! Maybe it's someone who's as concerned about natural disasters as you are!



Let's Practice!

Sally finds out more about how climate change is changing weather patterns all over the world.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Find out spelling mistakes. Write the words correctly.

- 1) As someone who is constantly studing weather phenomena, what can you tell us about the increase in nattural disasters globally?

- 2) The fields that they own are getngdrier.

- 3) The freshwater lakes that they use are becom saturated with poluants.

- 4) The data which was collected by our colleagues 20 years ago is now obsolet.

- 5) This seems to be a problem which people keep ignoryng, though.

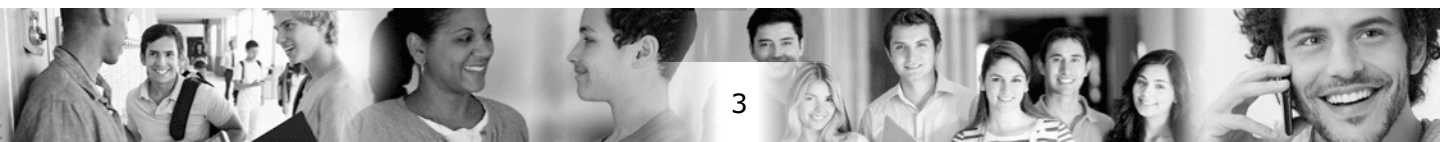


Let's Practice!

Brock Tameland was stressed by last night's news!

Instructions: Read the sentences. Underline all the Simple Past Passive verbs. Practice reading the sentences aloud with a partner. Model a conversation. Switch roles.

- 1) The environmental candidate was elected last night. It was an important night for him.
- 2) Mexico was hit by a large hurricane during the weekend. It destroyed many houses.
- 3) During my recent travels, I was shown the negative effect of climate change by many concerned locals who became activists.
- 4) Many books were published by world-renowned authors who are trying to raise awareness about the environment.
- 5) Hollywood has been trying to raise awareness about climate change recently, and I think some of those movies were made by the same director!





Extension Activity

Write a news story about natural disaster in your country in the passive voice.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a news story about a natural disaster that happened in your country.
- Use the Past Passive to make sentences (10 to 12 sentences) for your news story.
- Exchange stories with a partner and edit each other's stories focusing on the correct use of the Past Passive.
- Share with a partner and compare stories.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about natural disasters.

☐ ☐

I talk about past experiences and international news.

☐ ☐

I edit another person's work.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **globally** (adverb): involving the entire world
e.g. Natural disasters have increased globally.
- **pollutant** (noun): a toxic substance released into the atmosphere or in the water
e.g. Pollutants pose a threat to our freshwater lakes.
- **saturated** (adjective): loaded to full capacity; thoroughly impregnated
e.g. Freshwater lakes are becoming saturated with pollutants.
- **tornado** (noun): violently rotating winds resembling a funnel-shaped cloud
e.g. Tornadoes are affecting many areas in the summer.
- **heat wave** (noun): a prolonged period of unusually hot weather
e.g. The situation is made even worse by heat waves in the summer.
- **ice storm** (noun): a storm of freezing rain that leaves a coating of ice
e.g. Ice storms cause many problems in the winter.
- **blizzard** (noun): a severe snowstorm
e.g. Blizzards affect many areas in North America in the winter.
- **obsolete** (adjective): out of date, no longer relevant
e.g. The data that was collected by our colleagues 20 years ago is now obsolete.





Learning Points

Subject and Object Relative Clauses

When you want to clarify which person or thing you are talking about, you use a relative clause.

You can begin a relative clause with *who* for people, *which* for things or *that* for either people or things.

In spoken English you usually use *that*, rather than *which* or *who*.

You put the relative clause immediately after the noun it talks about.

A subject relative clause describes the subject of the clause.

Example:

The man who called wanted to speak to Tom.

Which man? The man who called.

The clause *who called* immediately follows man - the noun it describes.

An object relative clause describes the object of the clause.

Example:

Can you return the book that I lent you?

Which book? The book I lent you.

Example	Clause	Relative Pronoun	Type of Relative Clause
<i>The data which was collected by our colleagues 20 years ago is now obsolete.</i>	which was collected	which	subject
<i>The scientists who first studied climate change never imagined that things would get so bad.</i>	who first studied the climate	who	subject
<i>Hollywood is playing its part by releasing blockbusters that are raising awareness on this issue.</i>	that are raising awareness	that	object





Learning Points

Simple Past Passive

When you are writing a news article or giving an interview, you can include the Simple Past Passive to describe something done by someone at sometime in the past.

In a regular sentence structure, you use subject + verb + object.

Example:

Many concerned locals showed me the negative effects of climate change.

In the Simple Past Passive form, you use the structure:

Object + *was / were* + past participle + *by* subject

Example:

I was shown the negative effect of climate change by many concerned locals.

Examples:

- *Many books were published by world-renowned authors on the subject.*
- *I think some of those movies were even made by the same director!*

